

Participles

PARTICIPLES ARE FORMED FROM VERBS.

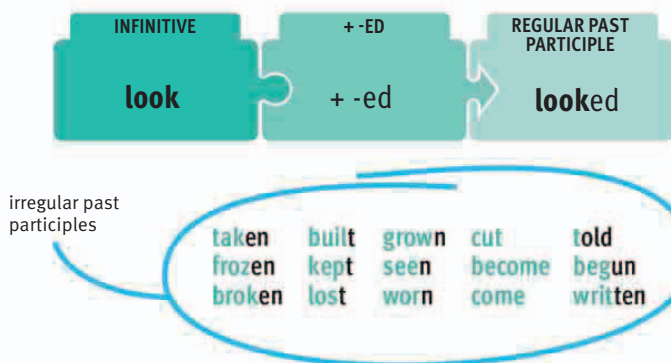
There are two participles: the past and the present. They are used with auxiliary verbs like *have* and *be* to form tenses, and on their own as adjectives. The present participle can also be used as a noun.

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Past participles as verbs

Combined with the auxiliary verb *have*, past participles are used to form the perfect tense of a verb. Regular past participles are formed in the same way as the simple past tense, using the infinitive, plus the ending -ed. Common irregular past participle endings include -en, -t, or -n. The past participle of a few verbs is the same as the infinitive, and some, such as *tell*, change their spelling completely.



Josh had **looked** everywhere for
been **hoping** to do some **ice-**



• Don't use the **wrong participle** as an **adjective**. An "interested cat" is not the same as an "interesting cat."

GLOSSARY

Auxiliary verb A "helping" verb like *be* or *have* that joins the main verb in a sentence to the subject.

Gerund The name given to the present participle when it is used as a noun.

Linking verb A verb that joins the subject of a sentence to a word or phrase that describes the subject.

Present participles as verbs

Present participles are used with the auxiliary verb *be* to form verbs in the continuous tense. They are formed using the infinitive and the ending -ing. Unlike past participles, all present participles have the same ending. If the infinitive ends in a silent -e (for example, *hope*), the -e is dropped before the -ing ending is added.

